

Sitara Competitive Landscape Dossier

Table of Contents

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Executive summary

Twenty-eight competitors were torn down across five clusters. The headline: **nobody occupies Sitara's bundle**. Across the entire market — India, the West, devotional apps, creator astrologers — no product combines (1) a chart-computed daily timing brief pushed to the user, (2) persistent life-context memory, (3) fixed-price verified human escalation under an ethics code, (4) family charts + festival/muhurat planning, and (5) one transparent annual price. The closest players ship at most two of the five.

The threat map, in one paragraph: **AstroTalk** (₹1,214 Cr FY25, IPO-bound at \$1–1.5B) owns the audience and the money but is structurally the anti-Sitara — per-minute meters, remedy upselling, Trustpilot ~2.9–3.2, explicitly “no AI predictions.” **AstroSage** owns the free-tools funnel (50M installs, 80%+ share of kundli searches) and ships the most AI in India (100M AI questions claimed, 8 languages) but has no subscription, no memory, and hallucination complaints. **Sri Mandir** is the most dangerous adjacent — \$53M raised, 700K international MAU growing 15%/quarter at ~₹7,000 NRI ARPU, already selling ₹599 fixed-price verified consults. **CHANI** (\$107.99/yr, ~\$14M revenue, bootstrapped, 4.9★) proves Sitara's exact model — premium, values-led, annual, female — but ships zero Vedic and zero AI. And two tiny players (**AstroNidan** \$99–149/yr, **Unfold** \$179/yr with memory + daily dasha forecast + 4 family profiles) are already probing Sitara's exact slot — sub-scale today, proof of the thesis, and a race clock.

1. Threat Tier 1 — Direct-High

1.1 AstroTalk (Codeyeti Software Solutions) — the category leader

What it is: India's largest astrology marketplace. Founded 2017 (Puneet Gupta, 72%; Anmol Jain). “Talk to real astrologers” — explicitly positioned AGAINST computer-generated predictions. Left Lane Capital \$20M Series A (2023); raising ~\$50–120M pre-IPO at \$1–1.5B; DRHP/H1-2026 listing in motion. The Hornbill Capital deal collapsed partly over explicit live-stream content found in due diligence.

Features (complete inventory): per-minute chat/call/video/live consults, 24/7, with ~45,000–48,000 listed astrologers (~half active; ~200 added/week; ~5% acceptance, 4-level vetting, 30-day monitoring). Discovery cards: per-minute price, rating, experience, order count, languages, specialisation (Vedic, KP, Nadi, Lal Kitab, Tarot, Numerology, Palmistry, Face Reading, Vastu, Western), “verified”/“Top Choice” badges, wait-times (~55 min peak). Free hook: first chat/call (~5 min). Free tools: kundli, kundli matching, daily–yearly horoscopes, blog. Live streams with **virtual gifting**. Prepaid wallet (iOS recharges \$5–\$1,000). Quasi-subscription: **Daily Pass ₹99/day × 10 days**. Commerce (AstroMall + AstroTalk Store, ~₹200 Cr ARR): gemstones, rudraksha, evil-eye, yantras, murtis, “Money Magnet” bracelets, e-pujas, reports. **Not present: memory, daily computed brief, subscription, family accounts, consumer AI.**

Pricing: ₹20–50/min typical (celebrity ₹126–136/min; documented range ₹10–250). Typical session ₹500–1,500. NRI: same marketplace billed in USD. Refunds: 1-hour cancellation window, discretionary, fee deductions.

Traction: FY25 revenue ₹1,214 Cr (+85%), adj. PBT ₹285 Cr; astrologers earned ₹511 Cr. 50M+ Play installs (4.6★, 1.49M reviews); iOS US 4.7★. **17% of revenue from NRIs; NRI ≈50% of web traffic.** Women = 57% of business; relationships/marriage = 60% of consults; repeat users spend 3x; CAC payback ~8 months.

AI: none consumer-facing — backend matching, instant kundli, chat-ops only. **Trust posture:** the soft underbelly — Trustpilot ~2.9–3.2; SproutsNews investigation alleges fake reviews and fear-selling (₹15,000 puja pattern; \$1,200–3,000 packages); sessions stretched to burn minutes; credit-only refunds.

Threat & Sitara’s answer: direct-high on audience, geography and money; near-zero product overlap today. Position against **the meter**, not the brand. Expect: pre-IPO trust-washing, a fast-follow subscription (the ₹99 pass is the seed), and an AI reversal (it holds the category’s best training corpus).

1.2 AstroSage + AstroSage AI (Ojas Softech) — the free-funnel + AI incumbent

What it is: founded 2004 (Punit Pandey); India’s dominant astrology platform: free SEO tool suite → Kundli app → Varta human marketplace → AstroSage AI (2024–).

Features: the deepest free chart engine anywhere — D-1–D-60 divisional charts, multiple ayanamsas, KP, Lal Kitab, Jaimini, Tajik varshphal, all dashas, Ashtakoot matching, panchang, muhurat, numerology, face reading. AI layer: “Talk to AI Astrologer” (chat + phone calls), AI Kundli, AI Horoscope; 20+ AI personas (chief persona “Mr. Krishnamurthi”); Vedic/KP/Lal Kitab/Nadi; **AI speaks 8 Indian languages**. Varta: ~30,000 astrologers, first minute free, wallet. Paid reports; gemstone shop. App in 17 languages. **No subscription, no memory, no proactive brief.**

Pricing: wallet only — intro ₹1/min — ~₹15/min typical — ₹150/min top; international \$0.25–1.42/min with strike-through discounts; minimum-balance gates (documented complaint: ₹70 stranded vs ₹75 minimum). AI: free daily allowance (130K+ free chats/day claimed) then wallet.

Traction: 50M+ installs, 4.3★/1.06M reviews; claims 1.2M DAU / 11M MAU / 80%+ kundli-search share; **AstroSage AI: 100M questions answered in ~10 months** (PTI PR). Bootstrapped.

Weaknesses: AI reviews cite inconsistency/hallucination; bait-rate escalation; refund friction; 5-week support delays; ad-saturated mass-market UX. **Threat:** the most capable fast-follower — engine + AI + distribution exist; a ₹99–199/mo subscription wrapper is “a quarter’s work.” Sitara’s defences: premium NRI positioning, memory, ethics, women-first design — everything AstroSage’s mass-market economics resist.

1.3 Sri Mandir (AppsForBharat) — the adjacent giant already in Sitara’s wallet

What it is: India’s largest devotional app (\$53M+ raised; Nilekani/Peak XV/Elevation/Susquehanna); astrology is a fast-growing attach (“Kundli Guide”).

Features: puja/chadhava at 70+ temples; prasad delivery; devotional AI (faith Q&A, prayers); **Kundli Guide: ₹599/30-min FIXED-PRICE video consults with credential-verified astrologers** (BHU/ICAS certs displayed) incl. chart analysis + remedies + follow-up summary; Hindi/English/Tamil/Telugu. No AI astrologer, no memory, no daily brief, no subscription, no family construct.

Traction: 40M+ downloads, 3.5M MAU, ~700K international MAU +15% QoQ, NRI ARPU ~₹7,000/yr, 55% 6-month retention; \$12M run-rate; profitability + IPO targeted 2027-28.

Threat: direct-high — it is already extracting Sitara-level revenue from Sitara’s exact NRI women, has half of Sitara’s trust posture (verified credentials, fixed prices), and could bundle an astrology membership in 1–2 quarters. Its structural conflict: remedy-commerce take-rate — its astrologers are paid to recommend pujas. Sitara’s answer: the ethics code Sri Mandir’s business model cannot adopt, plus depth (memory, daily brief) devotion-first apps won’t build.

1.4 Melootha (Astroverse) — the AI-native with the ethics story

Shark Tank India alum (all sharks passed; ₹40 Cr ask valuation); ~₹5.3 Cr angel (Streak Ventures). AI predictions from a proprietary engine encoding one astrologer’s method; personalised Q&A, compatibility, life-planning timing, daily horoscope, paid reports, **family profiles**, and an explicit **no-rituals/no-remedies stance (~70–75% accuracy claim)**. 1M+ installs, 4.3★/8.5K reviews. Pricing opaque (per-question packs + reports; users call it expensive). No memory, no daily push brief, no human escalation, no multilingual. **Threat:** the most direct Indian ideological competitor; a pivot to subscription+memory makes it Sitara’s twin overnight. Watch closely.

1.5 AstroNidan — already sitting on Sitara’s price point

NRI-focused Vedic AI platform. Free kundli/horoscope/matching; 25+ report types from ₹299/\$9; **annual tiers Pro ₹2,399/yr (~\$99) and Elite ₹3,999/yr (~\$149)**; “past-event validation” trust mechanic (claims 92% accuracy); 7-day refund guarantee. Self-claimed 500K users (unverified; discount heavily). No memory, no daily brief, no human layer, no family features. **Threat:** owns NRI SEO listicles for “best AI astrology” at Sitara’s exact price band. Beatable on product depth; dangerous on search real estate.

1.6 Unfold Astrology — the exact bundle, pre-scale

\$179/yr single tier (list \$215): degree-level Vedic engine (Rashi/Nakshatra/Dasha/Bhukti/transits), **AI chat WITH cross-session memory, up to 4 family profiles, five-card Daily Forecast** (today's energy, planetary watchlist, Mahadasha/Bhukti, transit tracking — the nearest in-market thing to Sitara's daily brief, pull-based), tarot, manifestation audio. Essentially zero verifiable traction (site counters show 0s). No voice, no human escalation, no muhurat, English-only. **Threat:** proof of WTP at \$179/yr for Sitara's core bundle — and a race clock. If Unfold adds human escalation or raises capital first, Sitara loses “first premium trust-first subscription” positioning.

2. Threat Tier 2 — Direct-Medium

CHANI — the premium trust-first analogue (Western). \$11.99/mo or **\$107.99/yr; ~\$14M revenue, bootstrapped, +50% YoY**, 2M+ downloads, 4.9★/55K reviews; 5% of revenue to gender-based-violence survivors; **explicitly zero AI** (“none of it is AI-generated”); human-written premium content: birth-chart readings, personalised transit readings, weekly rituals/meditations, Saturn-Return course, Year Ahead. Weaknesses vs Sitara: no Vedic, weekly (not daily/personal) cadence shared across rising signs, no memory, weak compatibility, no human consults, English-only. **The single most dangerous scenario in the whole dossier: CHANI ships a Vedic track.** Also the strongest validation that Sitara's model works at exactly \$107.99/yr.

Nebula (OBRIO/Genesis) — \$50M ARR, 30M users, elite quiz-funnel acquisition; \$7.99/week default billing with the category's worst documented dark-pattern record (post-trial charges, \$144 surprise annuals, failed cancellations, BBB scam-tracker). Threat is the machine, not the product: a “Vedic Nebula” funnel aimed at the diaspora could outspend Sitara 100:1. Sitara's answer: be the visible anti-Nebula (billing transparency as marketing).

Astroyogi (Netway) — FY24 revenue ₹84.3 Cr (+26%) but PBT ₹31,000 on ₹24 Cr ads; 27% international, 85+ countries, 1 Cr+ installs, 4.7★/154K. Per-minute (₹12–45+/min promo tiers), remedies commerce via quick-commerce (Blinkit/Zepto), targeting ₹250 Cr with AI + retail push. Documented ethics failures (animal-sacrifice suggestion in a review; ₹6,000–7,000 sessions; refund denials). AI is cosmetic today; co-founder says AI will assist, never replace astrologers.

InstaAstro — FY24 ₹25.1 Cr (+93%), loss ₹8.1 Cr; ₹1-first-consult hook; per-minute ₹75–363/min listed; 1 Cr+ installs, store 4.5–4.6★ vs **MouthShut 2.5/5**; celebrity ads. **Flipkart reportedly in talks to acquire (\$18–25M, possible “Sukh” rebrand)** — the structural threat is a super-app distributor bundling cheap astrology overnight.

GaneshaSpeaks (Wellness Technologies) — 2003 old-guard; ~2M monthly visitors; USD report storefront for NRIs (2026 Personalized Horoscope \$24.49; Monthwise \$59.99; perpetual 10–50% off anchoring); 200+ astrologer marketplace; Bejan Daruwalla heritage. Weak app (1M

installs), human-produced 72-hour reports, 3.3/5 aggregate reviews. Threat: could bundle reports+consults into a “yearly guidance” subscription for 45+ NRI women.

Independent Instagram/WhatsApp astrologers — the real incumbent for trust. Exemplar: Astro Arun Pandit — 2.4M IG, 2.75M YT, 120K+ kundlis, clients in 82+ countries, reports ₹999–5,000, courses, own app at ₹50/min. Standard independent band: **₹500–5,000/session**, zero verification/refunds, scarcity tactics, remedy upsell as default. They own the parasocial relationship and have zero CAC; a few credible female creator-astrologers launching subscriptions to their own audiences would attack Sitara’s exact segment. Sitara’s counter: recruit them — the verified-panel and ethics contract is also a creator-monetisation offer.

3. Threat Tier 3 — Indirect / Low (with reasons)

Anytime Astro (Innovana, BSE-listed parent) — most NRI-oriented mid-tier marketplace; chat from \$0.49/min USD-first; 5M installs, 4.5★; **markets “No AI predictions” as a trust feature** — previewing how incumbents will frame Sitara. Indirect. **Co-Star** — ~30M registered / ~800K monthly active; 4.8★/205K; à-la-carte (\$2.99–11.99; Pro-Star \$8.99/mo); human+AI editorial pipeline; famously harsh notifications (“Don’t even try to make yourself understood today”) generating mental-health backlash; no Vedic, no memory. Indirect — but its social compatibility loop is the viral mechanic Sitara’s family charts must match. **The Pattern** — Go Deeper+ \$14.99/mo/\$83.99/yr; Connect dating tier \$24.99/qtr; paid family-profile slots \$9.99–19.99 (**loved but nickel-and-dimed — validates Sitara’s included family charts**); 3.9 aggregate; undisclosed AI chat (trust wound); users verbatim: *“It’s not growing with me... doesn’t give you a daily what’s-going-on-today.”* Indirect. **Sanctuary** — per-minute human readings (\$2.99/min std; \$0.99 intro; 10-min blocks \$29.99–49.99; Sanctuary+ \$49.99/yr); 4.8★ store vs 33/100 safety score; queue-timer and expiring-credit complaints. The Western preview of Sitara’s human-escalation UX, minus pricing honesty. Indirect. **Hint** — \$1 trial — \$29.99/mo; “total scam” Trustpilot record, weekly-charge disputes; reputation destroyed. Low threat; a named cautionary pattern. **Stellium** — AI-native at \$24.99/yr and \$1.99/question; tiny (126 ratings). Proves the AI-chat layer alone commoditises to ~₹0 — Sitara must price continuity+humans+trust, never “AI chat.” **VAMA** — devotional + 1,000-astrologer marketplace; 1M installs, 4.3★; **Play data-safety label admits unencrypted data** — direct ammunition for a trust-first competitor. Indirect. **Guruji Astro** (3.5★, fraud allegations in reviews), **Astrobuddy** (telco-VAS alerts; per-topic fixed pricing — a rare honesty mechanic), **Tata Play Astro Duniya** (₹60/mo passive TV content — proof Indians pay recurring for astrology content; Tata/Jio waking up is a tail risk), **Bejan Daruwalla legacy** (fixed prices ₹2,100–6,500/session and a **₹5.11 lakh lifetime FAMILY consultation** — Sitara’s family feature priced 250x higher; validates fixed-price + family theses), **Clickastro/Astro-Vision** (1984; the best pure computation engine; ₹1,200–3,999 one-off reports in 11 languages; would license its engine to any copycat), **Future Point/LeoStar** (₹23,999 pro software; the tools Sitara’s panel astrologers already use), **matrimony kundli matching** (Shaadi/BharatMatrimony free 36-guna calculators — free anchor + dosha-fear funnel), **Drik Panchang** (1M+ installs, 4.6★/198K; the free reference for panchang/muhurat — data must be free in Sitara; monetise interpretation), **TimePassages/Astro Future**

(Western pro tools; Astro Future’s multi-profile family charting at \$29.99/yr is the only real family-chart workflow in the West), **numerology apps** (feature, not category), **Kundli-GPT wrapper class** (free/coin-based, universally reviewed as generic; AstroAI markets “Personal Jyotish that Remembers You” — watch the language).

4. Infrastructure (build-vs-buy for Sitara’s engine)

Option	What you get	Price	Verdict
Prokerala API	Kundli, divisional charts, panchang/choghadiya, Ashta+Dasha Kuta matching, KP, Western, PDF reports	Free 5K credits/mo — \$19/\$49/\$99/mo	Prototype here (weeks 0–8)
VedicAstroAPI	100+ endpoints, dosha/dasha, 21 languages, PDF ₹2–45/doc, white-label AI chat ₹1/credit	₹1,499–3,999/mo	Cheapest; note: it sells the “AI astrologer” to any copycat
Divine API	Vedic + dedicated muhurat finder , Western, horoscope feeds	Vedic \$19–149/mo	Muhurat endpoint useful for v1
Free Astrology API	Basic Vedic/Western	Free 50/day → ~₹1,000–6,500/mo	Demo only
Swiss Ephemeris (build)	0.001-arcsec positions, ~40 ayanamsas, all bindings	One-time CHF 700 (~\$790) professional licence (AGPL otherwise)	Production path

Recommendation (as researched): prototype on Prokerala/VedicAstroAPI; build the production engine in-house on Swiss Ephemeris (CHF 700 licence), implementing the Vedic layer (vargas, dashas, panchang, muhurta) validated against **Jagannatha Hora** and **Drik Panchang** outputs (~4–8 specialist weeks). Rationale: 50K subscribers × daily briefs ≈ 50M+ calls/yr (perpetual API fees vs one-time licence + pennies of compute); accuracy/ayanamsa transparency is the brand; and API vendors now rent white-label AI astrologers to anyone — don’t build a premium brand on a commodity your copycats can rent.

5. Feature-Comparison Matrix

Capability	AstroTalk	AstroSage AI	Sri Mandir	Melooha	Sitara (planned)
Vedic chart engine	via humans	✓ deep	via humans	✓	✓ (own, Swiss Eph)
AI chat on your chart	✗	✓ (8 langs)	✗	✓	✓ + explanations
Persistent life memory	✗	✗	✗	✗	✓ core
Daily chart-computed brief (pushed)	✗	✗	✗	✗	✓ core
Human astrologer access	✓ per-min	✓ per-min	✓ fixed ₹599	✗	✓ fixed-price, verified, context handoff
Subscription	₹99/day pass	✗	✗	✗	✓ \$99–199/yr · ₹3,999–7,999/yr
Family charts included	✗	✗	✗	✓ profiles	✓ + festival calendar
Muhurat/festival planning	content	tools	festivals	✗	✓ personalised
Ethics code / no remedy upsell	✗ (core revenue)	✗	partial	✓ stance	✓ contractual + published
Languages	13+ human	17 app / 8 AI	4	EN	EN/Hinglish/Hindi – regional
Trust record (external)	TP ~3.0	billing gripes	good	fair	to be earned
Capability	AstroNidan	Unfold	CHANI	Sitara (planned)	
Vedic chart engine	✓	✓	✗	✓ (own, Swiss Eph)	

Capability	AstroNidan	Unfold	CHANI	Sitara (planned)
AI chat on your chart	✓	✓	✗ (anti-AI)	✓ + explanations
Persistent life memory	✗	✓ (claimed)	✗	✓ core
Daily chart-computed brief (pushed)	✗	pull-based	weekly, shared	✓ core
Human astrologer access	✗	✗	✗	✓ fixed-price, verified, context handoff
Subscription	✓ \$99–149/yr	✓ \$179/yr	✓ \$107.99/yr	✓ \$99–199/yr · ₹3,999–7,999/yr
Family charts included	✗	✓ 4 profiles	✗	✓ + festival calendar
Muhurat/ festival planning	✗	✗	✗	✓ personalised
Ethics code / no remedy upsell	partial	clean	✓✓	✓ contractual + published
Languages	EN	EN	EN	EN/Hinglish/ Hindi → regional
Trust record (external)	n/a	n/a	excellent	to be earned

Capability	Co-Star	Nebula	Sanctuary	Sitara (planned)
Vedic chart engine	✗	✗	✗	✓ (own, Swiss Eph)
AI chat on your chart	pipeline only	✗	✗	✓ + explanations
Persistent life memory	✗	✗	✗	✓ core
Daily chart-computed brief (pushed)	generic daily	template	template	✓ core
Human astrologer access	✗	✓ per-min	✓ per-min	✓ fixed-price, verified, context handoff
Subscription	\$8.99/mo tier	\$7.99/wk	\$49.99/yr	✓ \$99–199/yr ·

Capability	Co-Star	Nebula	Sanctuary	Sitara (planned)
			content	₹3,999–7,999/yr
Family charts included	friends social	✗	✗	✓ + festival calendar
Muhurat/festival planning	✗	✗	✗	✓ personalised
Ethics code / no remedy upsell	clean	✗✗	meter	✓ contractual + published
Languages	EN	EN+	EN	EN/Hinglish/Hindi – regional
Trust record (external)	tone issues	worst	metering	to be earned

6. What the reviews say (the voice-of-customer layer)

Complaint cluster 1 — money handling (the #1 theme everywhere): non-refundable wallets, minimum-balance traps (AstroSage ₹70-vs-₹75 documented), bait rates (₹1/min – ₹15/min), abrupt session cutoffs forcing recharge (AstroTalk), queue-timer billing (Sanctuary), hidden weekly renewals and \$144 surprise annuals (Nebula), post-cancel billing (The Pattern). **Cluster 2 — fear-selling:** ₹15,000 puja pressure, \$1,200–3,000 packages, “refusal to accept no” (AstroTalk investigation); a session consumed entirely by upselling and an animal-sacrifice suggestion (Astroyogi reviews). **Cluster 3 — generic/recycled content and quality variance:** “generic advice I could find online,” contradictory astrologers, cold-reading scripts; Co-Star’s “Why is seaweed a do?”; Pattern’s recycled readings. **Cluster 4 — no continuity:** users only get memory by loyalty to one human; Pattern verbatim: “*It’s not growing with me.*”

What retains users (copy this): a named astrologer who remembers them (AstroTalk’s true retention engine); eerily specific personalised writing (Co-Star/Pattern); social/family chart comparison; substantive free education (Sanctuary, AstroSage); Stellium’s predictable pricing singled out for praise. **Store-rating inflation warning:** 4.5–4.8★ store scores coexist with 2.4–3.3 independent ratings and 11–33/100 safety scores across the category — expect diligence-grade skepticism of all store ratings, including from users.

7. The white space (validated feature gaps — no competitor ships these)

1. **Pushed, chart-computed daily timing brief** — the single clearest gap; users ask for it verbatim.

2. **Structured life-context memory** with predictions referenced and scored against outcomes (nobody runs an accuracy scorecard for *your* chart).
3. **Fixed-price verified human escalation with AI-to-human context handoff** — users pay per-minute to re-explain themselves everywhere today.
4. **Published, contractual no-fear-selling ethics code + real refunds** — structurally impossible for remedy-commerce incumbents.
5. **Family charts + NRI-timezone festival/muhurat calendar under one plan** (the only “family product” in the market is Bejan Daruwalla’s ₹5.11 lakh lifetime consultation).
6. **Honest “here is why, and how confident to be” explanations** — opacity is a stated user complaint on both continents.
7. **Women-first premium design** — 57% of the leader’s revenue is women, served a bazaar UX. No player has any gender-specific positioning.
8. **Dual-market transparent annual pricing** with zero wallets/meters/coins/strike-through discounts.

8. The five competitive responses to plan for

1. **AstroSage bolts a subscription onto its AI** at mass-market prices (a quarter’s work) — defend with premium NRI positioning, memory depth, ethics, women-first brand.
2. **AstroTalk trust-washes pre-IPO** and launches a “verified no-upsell” tier — defend with authenticity (their meter economics can’t follow) and speed.
3. **Sri Mandir bundles an NRI astrology membership** — defend with depth (daily brief, memory) and the remedy-conflict contrast.
4. **CHANI ships a Vedic track / OBRIIO clones a Vedic funnel** — defend by winning the diaspora community first and making billing transparency loud.
5. **Anti-AI counter-positioning** (“real humans, no AI” — Anytime Astro already runs it; CHANI and Sanctuary market it) — pre-empt with the hybrid story: deterministic computation + honest AI + verified humans, and never market “AI astrology” as the headline.

Data limitations: Trustpilot direct pages intermittently bot-blocked (ranges triangulated); Reddit blocked (sentiment directional via secondary sources); self-reported traction (AstroNidan, Unfold, Om.AI, creator astrologers) should be discounted; all pricing captured 28 July 2026 and will drift. Full per-competitor source URLs retained in the research corpus (~140 links).